



Vulnerability Information and Coordination Environment – New Technologies (VINCE-NT): Terms and Conditions



Platform Etiquette and Expectations

All users (including all relevant stakeholders, including vulnerability reporters, software manufacturers, maintainers, vendors, services providers) will act with respect and professionalism when using VINCE-NT. All users will refrain from using offensive language, personal attacks, threats and discrimination or harassment. These behaviors are not tolerated within VINCE-NT.

CISA will not link to any website that exhibits hate, bias or discrimination. Furthermore, CISA reserves the right to deny or remove any links for the following reasons (for information on DHS's Privacy Policy, please visit the [DHS Privacy Policy](#)):

- The linked website contains misleading information or unsubstantiated claims or is determined to be in conflict with CISA's mission or policies.
- At CISA's sole discretion.

While communicating in VINCE-NT, all shared information must pertain directly to a reported vulnerability and/or related case. Users should ensure that all messages are clearly written and remain relevant to the discussed vulnerability and/or case. It is strictly forbidden for users to submit classified government data.

For any information submitted by a non-federal entity through VINCE-NT that falls within the definitions of a cyber threat indicator (CTI) or defensive measure (DM) at 6 U.S.C. § 650 and is submitted for a cybersecurity purpose, CISA deems any such CTI and DM as submitted under section 104(c) and 105(c)(1)(B) of the Cybersecurity Information Sharing Act of 2015 (CISA 2015). Please do not include personal information not directly related to a cybersecurity threat in any submissions to VINCE-NT. For more information about sharing cyber threat indicators and defensive measures with the Federal Government under CISA 2015, see <https://www.cisa.gov/ais>.

All users must adhere to all applicable privacy laws and federal regulations. Additionally, requests pursuant to the Freedom of Information Act (FOIA) will undergo federal review. Though CISA is a Vulnerabilities Equities Process (VEP) member, anything reported by external researchers via VINCE-NT is **not** subject to the VEP (for more information, please review this document's CISA's *Vulnerability Disclosure Platform (VDP) Exclusion from section*).

VINCE-NT operates in accordance with the [Traffic Light Protocol \(TLP\)](#). According to the TLP processes, all vulnerability or case information discussed in VINCE-NT is designated as **TLP: AMBER + STRICT**. Unless CISA gives written approval, users should not share, release, or disclose any details outside VINCE-NT before the official coordinated publication date. Any information released in the published advisory is **TLP: CLEAR** and may be shared publicly. Any details not included in the advisory remain **TLP: AMBER + STRICT**. Sharing any **TLP: AMBER + STRICT** case details outside of

VINCE-NT and without authorization is strictly forbidden. Violating these rules can limit future participation in cases and/or lead to account termination from VINCE-NT.

Expected Response Times

Once a reporter submits a vulnerability to CISA through VINCE-NT, CISA reserves the right to publicly report this vulnerability via CVE assignment and publication of advisory (human readable and CSAF) after coordination has completed. During coordination, CISA expects researchers and/or suppliers to acknowledge CISA's questions within five business days. Users are expected to participate regularly in case coordination, including providing updates on analysis and mitigation efforts. If additional time is needed for analysis and mitigation, researchers and suppliers are expected to promptly inform CISA. Timely responses are essential for maintaining VINCE-NT operations and the Coordinated Vulnerability Disclosure (CVD) program's mission objectives. Per CISA's [disclosure policy](#), in the event a supplier is unresponsive or will not establish a reasonable timeframe for remediation, CISA may disclose vulnerabilities as early as 45 days after the initial attempt to contact the supplier is made regardless of the availability of a patch or update.

All vulnerability coordination between researchers, suppliers and CISA will be facilitated by CISA and its partners within VINCE-NT. Entities outside of case participants will not be included in the case's coordination unless unanimously approved by the researcher and supplier.

CISA's Coordination with Researchers

If a researcher's vulnerability submission includes the researcher's contact information, CISA may follow up with researcher for additional coordination. This follow-up may include clarifying questions on the vulnerability information provided and/or further discussions between the researcher and supplier. These follow ups are essential for CISA to understand the vulnerability and to assess the applicability of Common Vulnerabilities and Exposures (CVE) ID assignment. If a researcher fails to respond to CISA's inquiries and CISA is unable to gather additional information on the reported vulnerability, CISA reserves the right to close the case without resolution.

CISA's Coordination with Suppliers

CISA's CVD process strongly encourages affected suppliers to actively engage in case coordination. This coordination requires regular communication and information-sharing between CISA, the supplier, and researcher, facilitated by CISA coordinators. If the supplier fails to respond to CISA's coordination requests, forty-five days have passed since it was reported, and there is no active coordination from the supplier, CISA reserves the right to publish a public advisory and accompanying CVE record in accordance with CISA's CVD policy.

Code of Conduct

Per TLP processes:

- Case participants must not disclose information outside VINCE-NT unless they have received CISA's written approval.

- Cooperation between researchers and/or suppliers and U.S government entities may be required prior to CISA publishing a vulnerability advisory; if this occurs, CISA will facilitate all coordination.
- If Artificial Intelligence (AI) tools were used to discover a vulnerability, reporters must notify CISA of this fact when submitting the vulnerability in VINCE-NT.

CISA's Collaboration with Regulators

Regulators may be involved in coordination, or vulnerability details may be shared with regulators in cases where the vulnerable product or impacted entity is under their regulatory purview. If this occurs, CISA will coordinate with the case's researchers and/or suppliers in advance of the regulator being provided with information from the VINCE-NT record. CISA will request permission from suppliers to share specific case details with regulators. In some cases, submission of vulnerability information to VINCE-NT may serve as a component of a broader coordinated vulnerability disclosure program; however, the submission of vulnerability information to VINCE-NT does not, by itself, satisfy an entity's statutory or regulatory vulnerability disclosure or reporting responsibilities, if any.

Access for Federally Restricted Contacts/Entities

CISA will consider the status of researchers and suppliers (including contacts and entities) under other federal programs such as the [Consolidated Screening List \(CSL\)](#), [Office of Foreign Assets Control \(OFAC\)](#) and [Specially Designated Nationals \(SDN\) and Blocked Persons List](#) before coordinating with the contact/entity. If a party is subject to any of these or other such restrictions, a CISA coordinator will determine next steps with regards to coordination with the contact/entity as needed.

CNA (CVE Numbering Authority) Disclosure and Engagement

Roles on this platform are designed to support the CVD process. Users may be requested to collaborate with CNAs in accordance with established procedures. For further details and information on how suppliers can become CNAs (allowing suppliers to manage the assignment of CVEs for vulnerabilities in their scope), please review the [official CVE website](#).

Reference for CVD Page

For further details, consult CISA's [Coordinated Vulnerability Disclosure \(CVD\) page](#). This page provides supplementary guidance and resources. Please refer to it for process updates and support materials.